

Panda HSK — User Guide

Welcome! **Panda HSK** helps you learn Chinese vocabulary for the **HSK 1-4** exams. Your study buddy is **Bao**, a panda who reacts as you learn — and who *grows up* as you master more words. This guide walks you through everything the app can do.

Getting started

Open the app in any modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge, Firefox) on a phone, tablet, or computer. Nothing to install. Your progress saves automatically on your device.

At the **top**: Bao's seal logo and app name, your 🐼 **day streak**, and your **profile chip** (tap it to switch or create profiles). Below that is the **level menu**. At the **bottom** are four sections: **Study**, **Quiz**, **Browse**, and **Progress**.

Choosing your course

At the top of Study, Quiz, and Browse there's a **Course** selector. Tap it to switch which vocabulary you're learning:

- **HSK 1-4** — the 2000-word official list, grouped by level (HSK 1, 2, 3, 4).
- **Class lessons** — your course vocabulary, grouped by lesson (8.10, 8.17, ...), many with example sentences.

Each course keeps its **own memory progress**, so your HSK words and lesson words are tracked separately — but Bao grows from everything you learn across both. More courses can be added to the app later.

Choosing your group (level or lesson)

The **level menu** appears on Study, Quiz, and Browse. Instead of a long row of buttons, it's now a single compact selector that shows your current group (for example **HSK 4 · 1000 words**) with a ▼ chevron. Tap it to open the menu and pick a group; tap anywhere outside (or press **Esc**) to close it.

For the HSK course the groups are **HSK 1 / 2 / 3 / 4 / All**; for Class lessons they're each **lesson number** plus **All**. The app remembers your choice per course. (When new levels are added later, they appear here automatically.)

Meaning languages — English, Thai, Japanese

On the **Study** screen there's a **Meanings** row with three buttons: **English**, ไทย, 日本語. Tap to turn each language on or off. Whatever you pick shows on the back of flashcards **and** in Browse. Turn off the languages you already know to test yourself, or turn on two at once to compare.

Thai and Japanese meanings are helpful AI-generated study drafts. They're reliable for everyday vocabulary; a native speaker may refine a few. **Note:** Thai and Japanese for **HSK 4** are still being prepared — for now HSK 4 cards show **English** meanings, and the TH/JA toggles simply stay empty for those words until the drafts are added.

1. Study mode (flashcards)

This is where you learn at your own pace.

- **Tap the card** (or **Flip card**) to turn it over and see the pinyin, part of speech, and meaning(s).
- **Swipe left** for the next card, **swipe right** to go back. On a computer you can **drag** with the mouse, use the ◀▶ **buttons**, or the **arrow keys**. Tap or press **Space** to flip.
- 汉字 / 拼音 / **Meaning first** — choose which side shows first.
- 🗣 **speaker** reads the word aloud. It now appears on **both the front and the back** of every card, so you can hear a word before or after flipping.
- ★ (**star**) on a card flags it for extra review (find these later under Browse → ★ Review, or quiz them).

Rating a word (how memory tracking works)

After you flip a card, four buttons appear:

Button	Use it when...	Effect
Again	You didn't know it	Comes back very soon

Hard	You struggled	Comes back soon
Good	You knew it	Comes back later
Easy	Too simple	Comes back much later

Your honest rating sets when the word returns. Each word carries a status that grows with you:

New → Learning → Familiar → Mastered

- 🔍 **Study due** loads only the words that are ready for review right now.
- 🔀 **Shuffle** mixes the deck; ↺ **Restart** goes back to the beginning.

The deck now shuffles automatically each time you start (or switch group/course), so you no longer always begin at the same first word. Use ↺ **Restart** any time for a fresh shuffle.

2. Quiz mode

Tap **Quiz**, then set up your test:

- Type** — **Meaning** (汉字 → meaning), **Hanzi** (meaning → 汉字), **Listening** (hear it → pick the 汉字), or **Mixed** (a bit of each).
- Pool** — **This level**, **Due for review** (words ready to revisit), or **Marked hard** (your ★ words).
- Length** — 10, 20, or 30 questions.

Tap **Start quiz**. Pick the answer; Bao stamps 很好! for correct ones. Your quiz answers also update each word's memory status, so quizzing *is* studying. At the end you'll see your score, the XP you earned, and any new best. **Study missed** turns the words you got wrong into a quick review deck.

3. Browse mode

Tap **Browse** to see the whole list.

- Search** by hanzi, pinyin (with or without tone marks), English, Thai, or Japanese.
- Filter** by status: **All**, **New**, **Learning**, **Familiar**, **Mastered**, or ★ **Review**.
- Each row shows its HSK level and current memory status. Tap 🎧 to listen.

4. Progress (your dashboard)

Tap **Progress** to meet your panda and see how you're doing:

- Bao's stage** — your panda evolves as you master words: **Panda Cub → Bamboo Scout → Clever Panda → Scholar Panda → Master Panda → Sage Panda**. The bar shows progress to the next stage.
- Stats** — total XP, day streak, words mastered, and quiz accuracy.
- Memory map** — how many of the current course's words are New / Learning / Familiar / Mastered.
- Mastery by level** — your mastered count for HSK 1, 2, 3, and 4.
- XP — last 7 days** — a little bar chart of your recent effort.
- Recent activity** — your latest study, quiz, and mastery moments.

Earning XP

You earn XP for rating cards, answering quiz questions, and a bonus each time you **master** a word. Studying on a new day keeps your **streak** alive.

Profiles, back up & sync

Tap your **profile chip** (top-right):

- Switch or create profiles** — each keeps its own XP, streak, and memory progress. Great for sharing a device or keeping separate goals. Pick a name and a panda buddy emoji.
- Back up & sync** — there's no server, so your progress lives on this device. To move it, copy your **backup code** and paste it into the app on another device under **Restore from a code**. Keep the code somewhere stable, like a note or email to yourself.

Tips for steady progress

- A few minutes daily beats long, rare sessions — your streak and the 🕒 **Study due** pool are built for this.
- Rate honestly. "Good/Easy" too often means words won't come back when you actually need them.
- Use **Listening** quizzes to train your ear once the characters feel familiar.
- Star tricky words (★) and clear them with a **Marked hard** quiz.

Happy studying — Bao is rooting for you! 🌱